Reflection & Technical Skills Report

Tanyi Mthuli

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SN:45672202

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INTRODUCTION

In my journey to strengthen my technical expertise, I have engaged in a series of online courses that explored both practical tools and essential professional skills. These learning experiences spanned diverse areas such as time management, version control, Git and GitHub documentation, project management strategies, and network simulation using Cisco Packet Tracer. Each course offered not only theoretical knowledge but also hands-on insights, enabling me to grasp how these concepts function in real-world scenarios. This reflection report highlights the competencies I have gained and illustrates how they can be applied to future academic endeavors as well as within the IT industry.

Course 1: Manage Your Time

Reflection and Technical skills

In this course, I've learned to apply the **80/20 principle** to boost my productivity by pinpointing the vital few tasks that drive the majority of results. This has sharpened my analytical thinking and enabled data-driven decisions. As the guide mentions, the **80/20 principle** is crucial for streamlining work and boosting results.

The "One Thing" framework taught me to strategically focus on the most impactful action each day. This approach has significantly improved my prioritization skills, task scoping, and time-blocking. I am now better equipped to identify and concentrate on the "highest-return action," as the guide suggests.

Moreover, the emphasis on self-questioning and daily reviews has fostered metacognitive habits. I can now more effectively diagnose what triggers my procrastination and realign my efforts with my long-term objectives. These practices have helped me build better self-awareness and stay on track.

Course 2: Git Started with GitHub

Reflection and Technical skills

In this module, I've established a solid understanding of version control principles. I can now interpret **git status** outputs effectively, differentiating between *untracked* and *tracked* files, and maintaining a clean working directory. The process of staging changes using **git add** and committing them with **git commit** has become second nature, enabling me to prepare, record, and document code snapshots efficiently. These skills are directly applicable to collaborative development and continuous integration pipelines, which I am excited to explore further.

I now grasp how the three Git zones—**Working Directory**, **Staging Area (Index)**, and **Repository (Commit History)**—work together to maintain project history. Navigating directories, ensuring clean states, and identifying a *root-commit* have boosted my confidence in managing new repositories and collaborating with teammates without the worry of accidental data loss.

Course 3: Git Expert (4 Hours)

Reflection and Technical skills

I've completed the Git Basics course and feel confident that I now have a solid, practical foundation in version control. Installing Git across Windows, macOS, and Linux and verifying the setup taught me how to configure the environment (PATH, editor, credential manager) so the tools work seamlessly from any terminal. Working with the command line—using **cd**, **ls**, **mkdir**, **rm**, and especially the Git workflow (**git add**, **git commit**, **git push**), has become second nature, and I can now stage, unstage, and remove files without fear of losing work. The deeper topics on branching, merging, and safe undo operations (**git revert** vs. **git reset**) gave me the confidence to manage complex projects and collaborate with teammates using remote repositories.

Course 4: Project and Project Management

Reflection and Technical skills

In this course, I've gained essential technical skills for effective project management. I learned how to **break down projects into a Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)**, which is crucial for organizing and managing complex tasks. I also studied the expanded triple constraint—balancing cost, time, scope, risk, quality, and resources—to ensure comprehensive project planning.

The PMBOK process groups (initiating, planning, executing, monitoring and controlling, and closing) have provided a structured approach to guide projects from start to finish. I am now familiar with using both **Microsoft Project** and **Primavera P6**, which will allow me to select the best scheduling and resource-leveling tools for different project scales. The knowledge-area framework has sharpened my ability to integrate scope, schedule, cost, and stakeholder considerations into a cohesive plan, ensuring that all aspects of a project are well-coordinated.

Course 5: Cisco Packet Tracer

Reflection and Technical skills

Course 5 introduced me to Cisco Packet Tracer, a powerful tool for simulating networks without the need for physical hardware. Through this course, I became familiar with navigating the interface, building simple networks, and connecting multiple devices. I also learned how to configure devices, assign IP addresses, and establish wireless connections, while customizing the workspace to suit different scenarios.

This experience gave me a practical understanding of how networking environments can be designed, tested, and refined using software. By experimenting with configurations and observing how devices interact, I gained deeper insight into the flow of communication within a network and the flexibility that simulation tools provide for learning and problem-solving.

Conclusion

In summary, these courses have equipped me with both practical abilities and deeper insights that extend beyond the classroom. Each learning experience strengthened my grasp of essential tools and concepts that are widely used in the technology field. The knowledge gained not only enhances my academic growth but also prepares me to apply these skills confidently in professional IT environments.